

Between stone and memory

At the far western edge of Japan lies Yonaguni, where the gaze almost reaches Taiwan, and the sea already feels like it opens onto other worlds.

Here, facing the underwater formations, the boundary between geology and architecture begins to blur. Beneath the surface, immense angular structures rest in silence, terraces, steps, sharp walls, as if the stone had been cut, ordered, conceived. Natural formation or human intervention, the debate remains open, and it is precisely there that the mystery resides.

Yonaguni offers no inscriptions, no certainties, only shapes too regular to be ignored, too ancient to be easily explained. They sleep beneath the water, battered by currents, observed by divers the way one contemplates an unsolved riddle, with equal parts caution and fascination.

Around these submerged stones drift distant echoes, Tiwanaku in the Andes, the Maya, the Minoans, the Jōmon culture, Rapa Nui. Civilizations separated by oceans, yet sometimes connected by similar intuitions, monumental stonework, cosmologies, relationships to time and to the earth.

And once again, my grandfather Antonio seems to continue walking beside me. Not as a fixed memory, but as a diffuse presence, emerging through landscapes, ancient stones, and the names whispered while facing the sea. Here, as elsewhere, I feel his gaze resting on these enigmas, he who believed in lost civilizations and invisible links between worlds. As if the journey never fully belonged to me, but quietly extended his own.

Summits as vestiges of a larger continent, perhaps submerged twelve thousand years ago. Coincidences, or fragmented memory of an ancient world. Here, the sea does not erase everything, it also keeps its silence.
